

Adding a Voltage Ratio Reading

This guide assumes you've been through [1 DigitalInput.md](#) and have a working file that changes a circle when a digital input button is pressed.

We're going to swap out our DigitalInput channel for a **VoltageRatio** channel - a continuous value roughly between 0 and 1, which is what Phidget's analog sensors, like the slider, report.

Step 1 — Add CSS for the ratio visual

This time we are starting with *style* ...

To represent the voltage ratio value, we are going to add a progress that changes in response to a user moving the slider. Your `<style>` block already has a `/* Button visual */` section for `#buttonVisual`. Add a new `/* Voltage ratio visual */` section after it:

```
/* Voltage ratio visual */
#ratioVisual {
  margin: 32px auto;
  max-width: 480px;
}

#ratioValue {
  font-size: 2.4rem;
  font-weight: bold;
  text-align: center;
  font-family: "Courier New", monospace;
}

#ratioBarTrack {
  width: 100%;
  height: 24px;
  background: #d9dce1;
  border-radius: 12px;
  overflow: hidden;
  margin-top: 12px;
}

#ratioBarFill {
  height: 100%;
  width: 0%;
  background: #3a9d4f;
  transition: width 0.1s ease;
}
```

Step 2 — Add markup for the ratio visual

In the body, you already have a section for the button:

```

<section>
  <h2>Button State</h2>
  <div id="buttonVisual" class="neutral">NEUTRAL</div>
</section>

```

Add a new section right after it:

```

<!-- The voltage ratio visual -->
<section>
  <h2>Voltage Ratio</h2>
  <div id="ratioVisual">
    <div id="ratioValue">--</div>
    <div id="ratioBarTrack">
      <div id="ratioBarFill"></div>
    </div>
  </div>
</section>

```

There's no `pressed` / `neutral` -style class here — a voltage ratio doesn't have two discrete states, so there's nothing to toggle. Instead there are two elements JavaScript will reach into separately: `#ratioValue` (the number) and `#ratioBarFill` (the bar's width). `--` is a placeholder shown before we've received a real reading, matching the "Waiting for connection..." placeholder already used in the raw state panel.

Step 3 — Add element references

In the script block, you already have a line for the button visual:

```
const buttonVisual = document.getElementById("buttonVisual");
```

Add two new lines beneath it for the elements from Step 2:

```
const ratioValue = document.getElementById("ratioValue");
const ratioBarFill = document.getElementById("ratioBarFill");
```

Step 4 — Add a second Phidget object variable

You already have:

```
let digitalInput;
```

Add a second `let` declaration for the new channel, right after it:

```
let voltageRatioInput;
```

Both channels will be created, opened, and closed independently, so each gets its own variable to hold onto the object between callbacks.

Step 5 — Add a display helper for the ratio

You already have `setButtonVisual` . Add a new function after it:

```
// Voltage ratios from this sensor type range roughly 0 - 1
function setRatioVisual(ratio) {
  if (ratio == null) {
    ratioValue.textContent = "--";
    ratioBarFill.style.width = "0%";
  }
  else {
    ratioValue.textContent = ratio.toFixed(4);
    ratioBarFill.style.width = `${ratio * 100}%`;
  }
}
```

This follows the same pattern as `setButtonVisual` — it just takes a number instead of a boolean. A few details worth understanding:

- **The `null` guard clause.** `setButtonVisual` never needed this because a button's state is always `true` or `false` . This function needs to handle "no reading yet" as a distinct case, since we'll call `setRatioVisual(null)` on disconnect (Step 8) to reset the display.
- **`ratio.toFixed(4)`** formats the number to 4 decimal places (e.g. `0.5731`) so the display doesn't jump around with long floating-point noise like `0.57309999997` .

Step 6 — Add the voltage ratio channel inside `connectToPhidgetServer`

Inside `connectToPhidgetServer` , you already open the digital input channel:

For now, comment that method out (using `//`). We can connect multiple channels at time, but we only have 1 wire available for our demo.

Add a method to open a Voltage Ratio input, and call that method inside `connectToPhidgetServer`:

```
async function connectToPhidgetServer(address, port) {
  ...

  await connection.connect();

  // await openDigitalInput();
  await openVoltageRatioInput();

  setConnectedUI(true);
}

async function openDigitalInput() {
  ...
}

async function openVoltageRatioInput() {
  voltageRatioInput = new phidget22.VoltageRatioInput();
```

```

voltageRatioInput.isHubPortDevice = true;
voltageRatioInput.hubPort = 0;

voltageRatioInput.onAttach = () => {
  updateRawStatePanel({
    status: "Attached",
    deviceName: voltageRatioInput.deviceName,
    serialNumber: voltageRatioInput.deviceSerialNumber,
    channel: voltageRatioInput.channel,
    voltageRatio: voltageRatioInput.voltageRatio
  });
  setRatioVisual(voltageRatioInput.voltageRatio);
};

voltageRatioInput.onDetach = () => {
  updateRawStatePanel({ status: "Device detached" });
  setRatioVisual(null);
};

voltageRatioInput.onVoltageRatioChange = (voltageRatio) => {
  setRatioVisual(voltageRatio);
  updateRawStatePanel({
    status: "Voltage ratio change",
    deviceName: voltageRatioInput.deviceName,
    serialNumber: voltageRatioInput.deviceSerialNumber,
    channel: voltageRatioInput.channel,
    voltageRatio: voltageRatio,
    timestamp: new Date().toISOString()
  });
};

await voltageRatioInput.open(5000);
}

```

A few things worth noticing:

- `phidget22.VoltageRatioInput()` is a different channel class from `phidget22.DigitalInput()` — this is the line that tells the library what kind of hardware to look for. `isHubPortDevice = true` and `hubPort = 0` mean the same thing here as they did for the digital input: "the channel plugged into port 0.". If we wanted to connect multiple sensors at the same time, we'd need to update the `hubPort` to match which port each sensor is actually connected too.
- `voltageRatioInput.voltageRatio` is the property this channel type exposes for its current reading, the same way `digitalInput.state` was the property for the button. It's read once in `onAttach` (in case the sensor already has a value the moment we connect) and passed along on every `onVoltageRatioChange`.
- **Note there's no ! inversion here**, unlike `setButtonVisual(!state)` for the button. That inversion was a workaround for that particular sensor. A voltage ratio is a continuous physical measurement, so `setRatioVisual(voltageRatio)` passes the raw value straight through.

Step 7 — Add cleanup for the voltage ratio channel on disconnect

You already have:

```

async function disconnectFromPhidgetServer() {
  if (digitalInput) {
    try {
      await digitalInput.close();
    } catch (error) {
      // Channel may already be closed – nothing to do here.
    }
    digitalInput = null;
  }
  setButtonVisual(false);
  setConnectedUI(false);
  updateRawStatePanel({ status: "Disconnected" });
}

```

Add a matching block for the voltage ratio channel, and a call to reset its visual, without touching the existing lines:

```

async function disconnectFromPhidgetServer() {
  if (digitalInput) {
    try {
      await digitalInput.close();
    } catch (error) {
      // Channel may already be closed – nothing to do here.
    }
    digitalInput = null;
  }
  if (voltageRatioInput) {
    try {
      await voltageRatioInput.close();
    } catch (error) {
      console.warn(error);
      // Channel may already be closed – nothing to do here.
    }
    voltageRatioInput = null;
  }
  setButtonVisual(false);
  setRatioVisual(null);
  setConnectedUI(false);
  updateRawStatePanel({ status: "Disconnected" });
}

```

Each channel gets its own guarded close, since either one could already be closed or never have successfully opened. Both display resets (`setButtonVisual(false)` and `setRatioVisual(null)`) run before the final status update, so the page returns to a fully neutral state regardless of which channels were active.

Trying it yourself

1. Make sure a Phidget Network Server is running and reachable, with a voltage ratio sensor (the slider sensor) plugged into hub port 0.
2. Open your updated file in a browser.
3. Enter the server's address and port (default `localhost:8989`) and click Connect.

4. Watch the raw state panel for "Attached" messages as each channel comes online. Move the sensor — the number and bar should update.

Bonus Round

Again, let's make this more fun. Try adding css `transform` styles to an image to reflect where the slider is.